Abhayagiri Daylong on Fear

Saturday, October 10, 2020 9:16 AM

Fear
The better angels of our nature
Point back to the human experience
Central teaching of the buddha
Dukkha - suffering - it is an experience
Disease and stress
Points to stress and the ending of stress
Logical and rational reasons to be experiencing fear currently
Self
Other people you know
Economic impacts of covid

The most fear he felt
6th year practicing on his own
Jungle near Burma in Thailand
Walking meditation
Rustling and the a smell
Didn't formulate that is a tiger
Fear was physical first then the perception it was a tiger
Sutta - he was still searching for truth
He would stay in that same posture and investigate it until it dissipated
He worked with the fear, loving kindness for all beings including myself
Might be his last night
Work with it
Tendency of the mind to spin out
Come to body and rest in awareness
"Awareness and knowing a place of true abiding"
Stories…. Breath coming in and coming out
Rest in that awareness, comfortable and at ease. The rest can drop away.
It is not that tyou listen to the narratives
Reconfigure the context
Dwell in qualities that are a refuge
It is in our ability to know and to see clearly.
To experience what is truly good, beneficial or not
Bright qualities of the heart and what is not.
Be able to see this.
Fundamental , without the story of me, faith and confidence in those underlying truths

The better angel of our nature
With us all the time
Me don't make it.
It needs to be known,, recognized, given attention

So many things vying for our attention, we have a story for all of them
They all cause stress even if they are good

Seeking happiness, cause suffering
A burden

What are we drawn to what is more beneficial, sustaining
Lay a foundation for living - not being driven by fear.
Not being intimidated by it.
Known for what it is.

Peace and wellbeing that arises.

Our day today.
Exploration of this quality of knowing, paying attention, what is obstructing that know
Instead of pushing away, being able to - deep listening -
1st teaching of the buddha 4 noble truths
Appropriate response to each truth
The experience of these
---To be known understood - not reactive - fear, confusion, aversion
Even with pleasant feelings - if it is responded to nourishing okay - if with suspicion - or clinging then we can crush it.
-- mindfulness - present moment plus context/understanding/has conditions that predicated it.
Our experience will continue on out of that (karma)

Broad awareness that understands context - cause and condition - direction we want to encourage for ourselves -

Fear - tends to contract - establish awareness - expansive quality - possibilities - how to we explore and encourage exploration - not retreating

Fear -as a theme - Monestary - fearless mountain - Abhayagiri - baya fear - giri mountain

Baya also security/safety

He and Amaro 1996
Amaro suggested the name
Place of safety and security

Fearless Mountain - develop where ever you are!!!!!

Sit in meditation
Attention to posture
Sit in a way -- back kind of straight - balance and ease

Breath can come into the whole body
Natural flow
Whole body affected
Soften
Taking an interest in the process of breathing
In the ordinary
Allowing the awareness to sustain itself
The mind is aware all of the time
Masked by everything else
Let things settle
Rhythm of the breath - of knowing - of being aware
How can I relax so it feels comfortable?
Relaxing into what we are doing already….

A big part of meditation especially in Thai forest is
Also walking, chores meditation,
Not one single posture
Mind and hearts in any posture or situation
15 to 25 paces
Pay attention to each part of movement
A lot it is just paying
Mindfulness in different activities that we have and carry meditation with us

Not wandering aimlessly meditation
Fixed path
Posture
America sign of walking in leading forward -
Bring attention into the body
Not barging forward - body following behind.
Pay attention to the transitions
What do we carry into the next moment
…
Coming into the core of your body
Crutial to how we live
A way of living
How we cultivate mindfulness and awareness

Standing meditation
Settling into an upright posture
Paying attention to the breath, shoulders, notice mind wandering, will get off balance

Are we present?
Sensation of touch
Connected to the ground - settling quality to that
Instead of thinking what you are doing

Paying attention one step at a time - like breath
When we get to the end of the path
stop turn around and stop mentally am I present am I here.
When collected continue
Softening the body.

Are we contracting are we holding
If relaxed and settled, there is not place for anxiety or fear, or restless worry
It doesn't land…….

Naniko Bhikkhu